

OPENING GUIDE

Queen's Gambit

Complete playbook for the Queen's Gambit with accepted and declined lines.

Playbook

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The Queen's Gambit: 1.d4 d5 2.c4

The Queen's Gambit is not a true gambit — White can usually regain the pawn. It's one of the most respected and strategically rich openings in chess.

Queen's Gambit: 1.d4 d5 2.c4



The Core Idea

White offers the c-pawn to gain central control. If Black takes (2...dxc4), White can recapture or build a strong center with e4. If Black declines, White maintains pressure on d5.

Queen's Gambit Declined

After 2...e6, Black supports d5 but locks in the light-squared Bishop. The main plans revolve around piece development and central tension.

Orthodox Defense

2...e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 — the classical setup. White develops methodically while maintaining central pressure.

Tartakower Variation

2...e6 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e3 O-O 6.Nf3 h6 7.Bh4 b6 — Black fianchettoes the problem Bishop. A reliable and solid choice.

Queen's Gambit Accepted

After 2...dxc4, Black takes the pawn. White should not rush to recapture — instead, develop and build the center.

Key Ideas for White

- Don't recapture immediately — develop first with e3 and Bxc4
- Build the ideal center with e4 when possible
- The c4 pawn is hard for Black to hold long-term
- Quick development leads to a natural advantage

Strategic Themes

The Minority Attack

In the QGD, White often advances the queenside pawns (a4-b5) to create weaknesses in Black's pawn structure. This is one of the most important strategic ideas in chess.

The Central Break

Black often aims for ...c5 or ...e5 to free their position. Timing these breaks correctly is crucial.

Ø=Ü; TIP: The Queen's Gambit is a strategic opening. Focus on understanding pawn structures and piece placement rather than memorizing long variations.